

COMMITTED TO SEE THE PROCESS THROUGH

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The USA Cricket chairman explains why the board has **refused to step down** and outlines its concerns over alleged contractual breaches and compliance violations.

USA Cricket chairman Venu Pisike insists the board will meet a three-month deadline set by the International Cricket Council to hold elections and fill vacant positions — a crucial step to comply with United States Olympic & Paralympic Committee (USOPC) bylaws and retain ICC membership.

Even as the board grapples with a damaging standoff with commercial partner American Cricket Enterprises (ACE), Pisike remains committed to see the process through. In this interview, he explains why the board has refused to step down and outlines its concerns over alleged contractual breaches and compliance violations.

When were the last USA Cricket elections, and why are some positions still vacant?

We have three categories of directors. First, independent directors appointed by the board. Second, athlete (player) directors — national players elected by their peers. Third, directors elected by

membership, which is my category; there are five of those seats. The terms of all five current elected directors, including mine, end at the close of this year; elections for all five will be held then.

Under the current constitution there should be four athlete directors, but we only have two because the constitution was amended recently to add two more seats — those additional elections are still pending.

The main delay was aligning with USOPC guidelines. Besides holding player elections we had to establish an Athlete Advisory Council (AAC) — drafting its charter, bylaws, election criteria, registration and eligibility rules. That back-and-forth with the USOPC took more than six to seven months.

The Nominations & Governance Committee (NGC) — one member appointed by USA Cricket, one by the ICC, and one by the player directors — also had a delay. The ICC seat was vacant; replacing an ineligible member took the ICC almost three months. While we waited, the elections were on hold.

When we were finally ready, further constitutional amendments were required by the final USOPC guidance which (in turn) required membership approval; those were approved in late May. Then the ICC Normalisation Committee announced a visit to the U.S., so we paused until we understood its direction.

Among the independent directors, one seat is vacant and another requires reappointment. The NGC has begun that process — it invites applications, interviews, vets and recommends candidates to the board. However, because athlete director elections remain pending, NGC is ready to make its recommendations immediately after the full board (with the new athlete directors) is in place.

What was the board's response to the ICC Normalisation Committee's directive asking the entire board to resign?

The majority declined to resign. Initially, I was prepared to step down because I had asked the ICC to intervene on the MLC contract. We